



Influence of Threat levels and Eco-Anxiety on Pro-Environmental Attitudes

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Introduction:

- **Climate change** is a major issue, the severity of which is increasing rapidly due to **human behavior**.
- Change in pro-environmental behaviors depends on **environmental attitudes**.
- Not much research has been done on the **effect of threat level framing** on **environmental attitudes**.
- The current study examined the effect of threat level framing on environmental attitudes, using eco-anxiety as a moderator.



Hypothesis:

We hypothesized that **environmental messages** and **images framed** with a moderate **threat level** would have the greatest influence on an individual's **pro-environmental attitudes**. Additionally, that preexisting **eco-anxiety** would affect this relationship.

Low Threat



"Coastal areas are at risk of slight flooding and erosion due to rising sea levels."

Moderate Threat



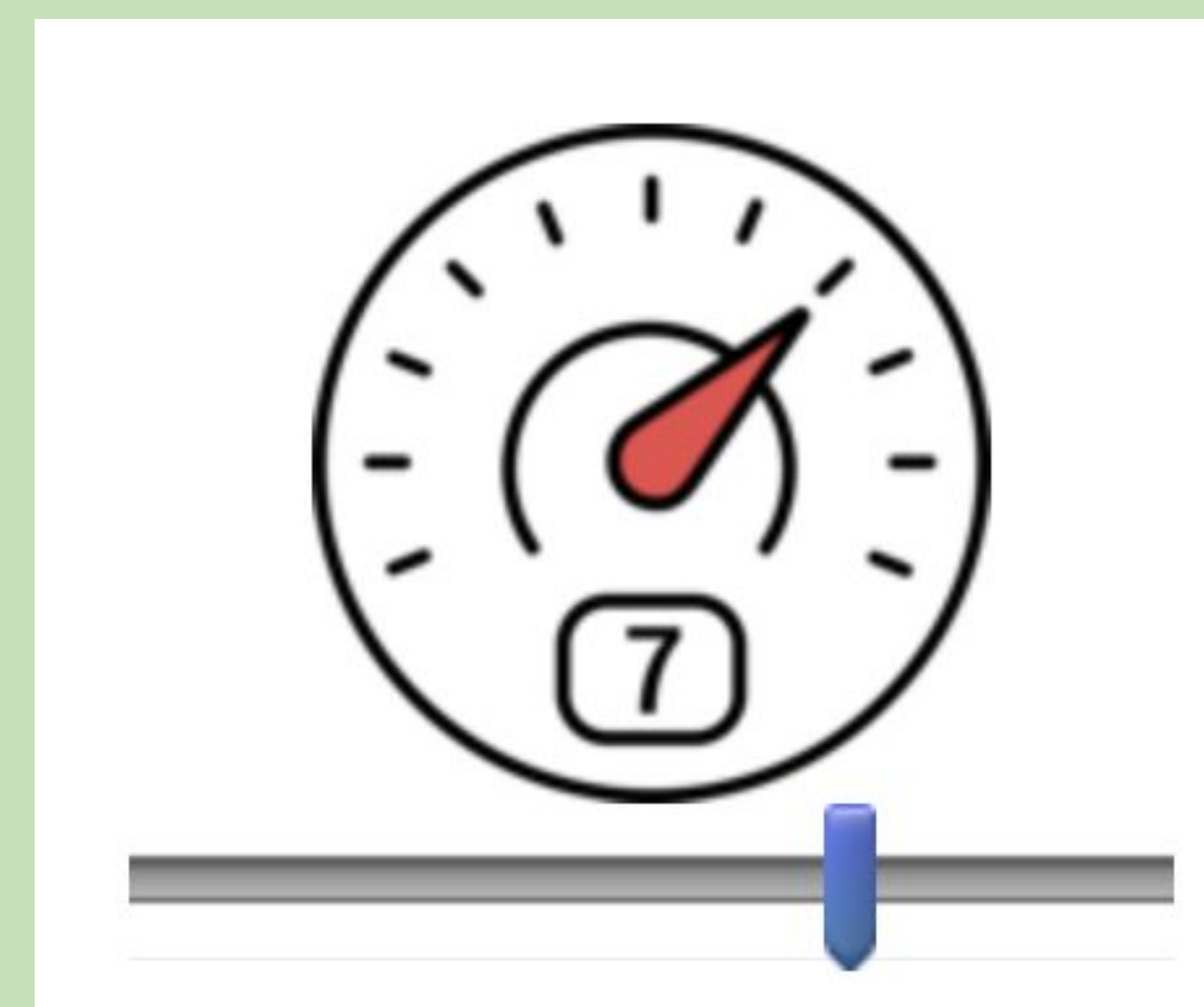
"Coastal areas are at risk to be significantly affected by severe flooding and erosion due to rising sea levels."

High Threat



"Coastal areas are going to be in utter destruction after storms, creating extreme floods due to rapidly rising sea levels."

Figure 1: Qualtrics slider scale measuring self reports of anxiety after viewing varying levels of threat phrases and images.



Scales Used:

- Hogg Eco-Anxiety Scale
- Brief Version of Environmental Attitudes Inventory

Discussion of Findings:

- Our results show that there was no correlation between **threat level messaging** and **environmental attitudes**.
- However, we found that higher levels of measured **photo anxiety** and **eco-anxiety** had higher levels of **preservation attitudes** towards the environment, and lower levels of **utilization attitudes**.

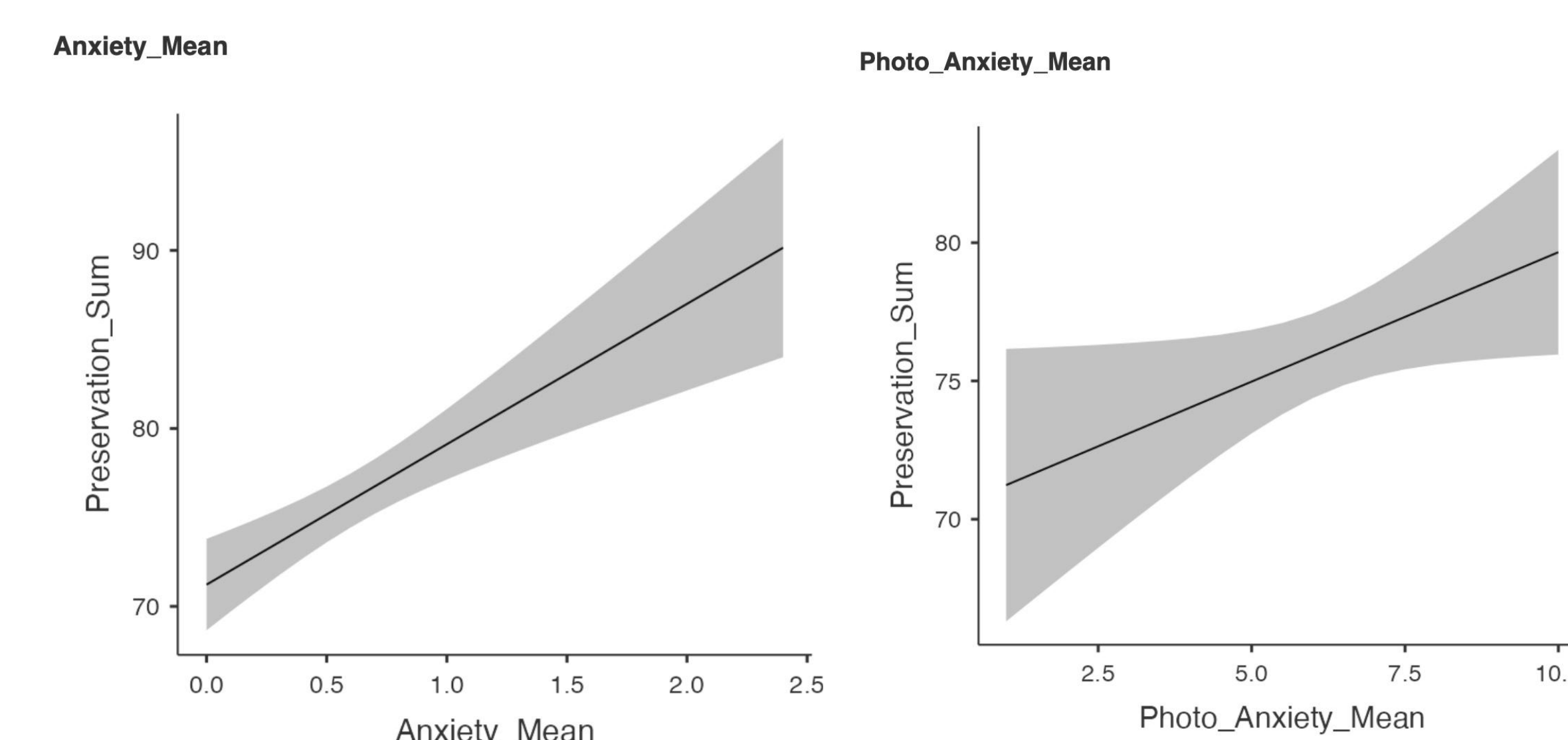


Results:

*Significant
*Nonsignificant

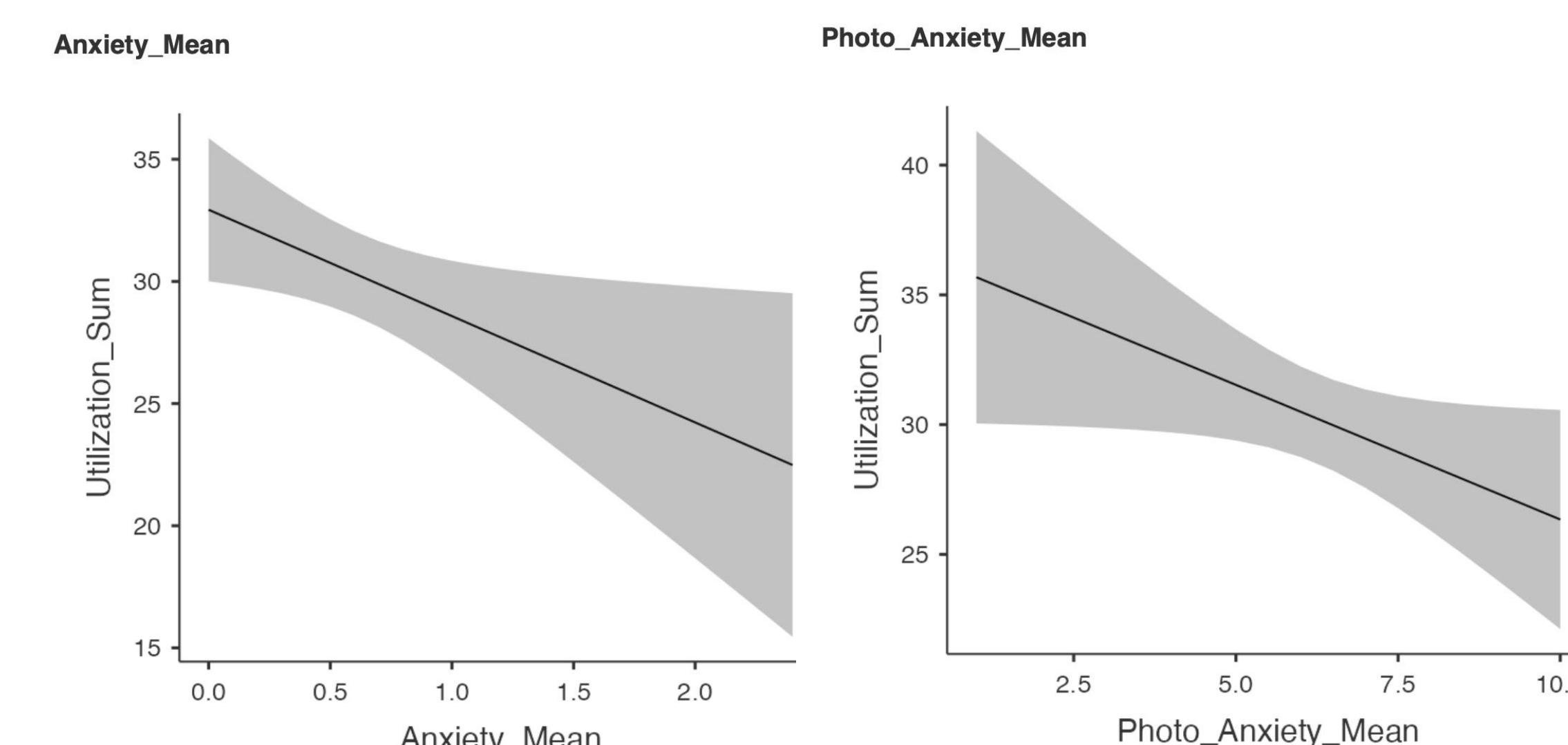
Environmental Preservation Attitude

- Predictor variables:
 - Eco-anxiety ($p < .001$)
 - Photo anxiety ($p = .041$)
 - Threat level ($p = .570$)



Environmental Utilization Attitude

- Predictor variables:
 - Eco-anxiety ($p = .026$)
 - Photo anxiety ($p = .047$)
 - Threat level ($p = .909$)



Real world Implications:

- Communication regarding the environment
- Effective ways to structure pro-environmental
- How to think about Eco-anxiety as a variable in communication